OCSA · PRODUCTION & DESIGN CONSERVATORY

Alex Kim's Portfolio

Apps, characters, building and theatre: the things I make and why.







INSIDE

Hearth a wellness app I designed and coded
Meet the crew characters from sketch to 3D
Building & Making birdhouse, glider and a fort
Encanto performing in a musical

DESIGN & TECHNOLOGY · APP DESIGN

Hearth

A wellness app that grows with you



WHAT IT IS

Hearth is a wellness app built around a daily ritual: each morning it asks “What would make today feel tended?” and you set three small intentions. A quick check-in on your mood, energy and stress shapes kinder goals, an “I’m feeling” page suggests ways to cope, and you get a companion that grows with your streak.

MY ROLE

I was the designer and coder: I came up with the idea, designed every screen and feature, and coded it by directing an Agent coding tool for the OC Student AI Network.

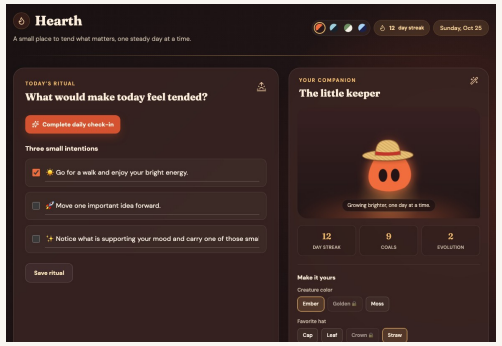
WHY I INCLUDED IT

Like a lot of students, I juggle assignments, deadlines and social pressure, and I wanted a calm way to take each day one step at a time. I noticed a lot of people make games, so I wanted to make something that stood out and could actually help.

3	28	0
intentions a day	days to the final form	data collected

Colors that match your mood

Colors change how people feel, so I designed four calm themes you can switch between depending on your mood. Each one comes from a place or memory that makes me feel calm.

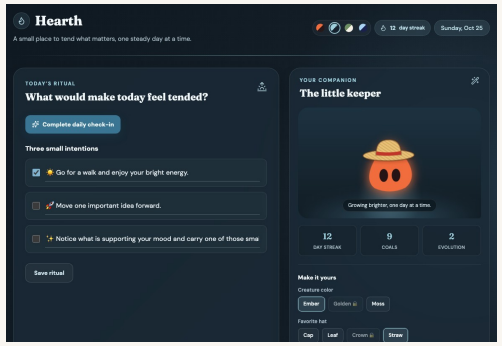


Ember

Cozy and comforting

From camping trips with my mom, where the campfire is one of the most comforting feelings I know.



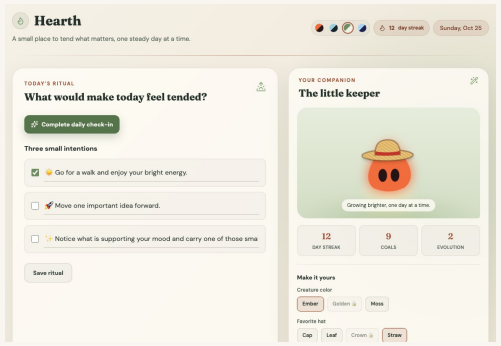


Tidepool

Serene and connected

From exploring tide pools as a kid, where every animal was relaxed and the ecosystem worked as one.



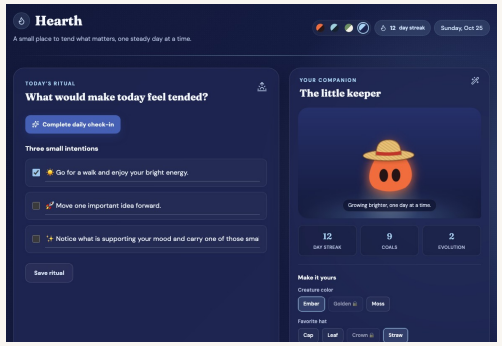


Morning Meadow

Fresh and hopeful

From mornings lying in the grass under a blue sky, with nowhere to be and a whole new day ahead.





Marshy

Soft and safe

From Marshy, my sequined midnight-blue sheep, who kept me company on the darkest nights.



Turning problems into solutions

1 Think

I sat down and asked myself what tool could make the world better and isn't out there enough.

2 Outline

I wrote the main outline: a daily check-in, three goals, and a creature that grows.

3 Build

I built it by prompting an Agent coding tool, one feature at a time.

4 Test & fix

I tested each part, and when something broke I found another way.

WHAT DIDN'T WORK, AND WHAT I DID ABOUT IT

The app wouldn't load — FIXED

My first version wouldn't run at all.

Fix: I loaded it on a personal account, and it worked.

The Agent got stuck on goals — FIXED

It kept misreading the goals feature and handing back the same broken answer, no matter how I prompted it.

Fix: I turned the problem into the solution: a goal tracker you set up yourself with short surveys.

The shop locks free hats — IN PROGRESS

The Agent decided you have to buy the free hats for your creature.

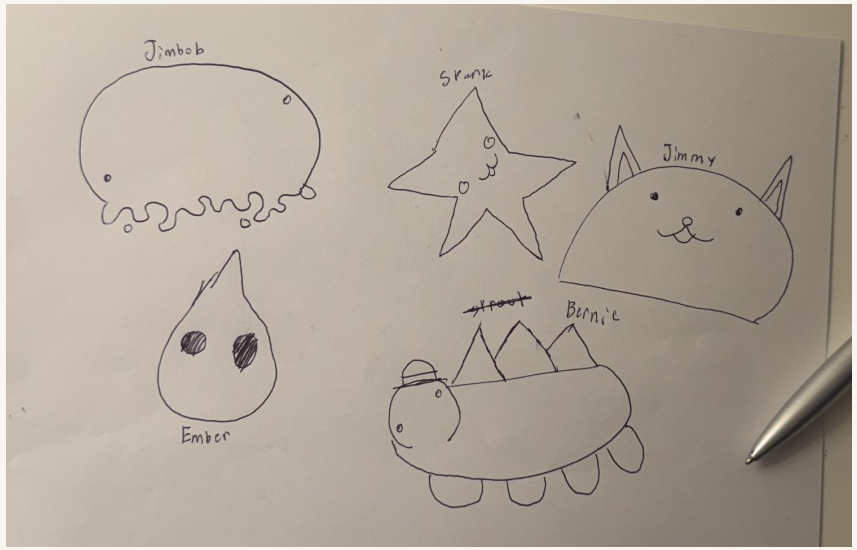
Fix: Still working on it, and it's next on my list.

CHARACTER DESIGN · SKETCH TO 3D

Meet the crew

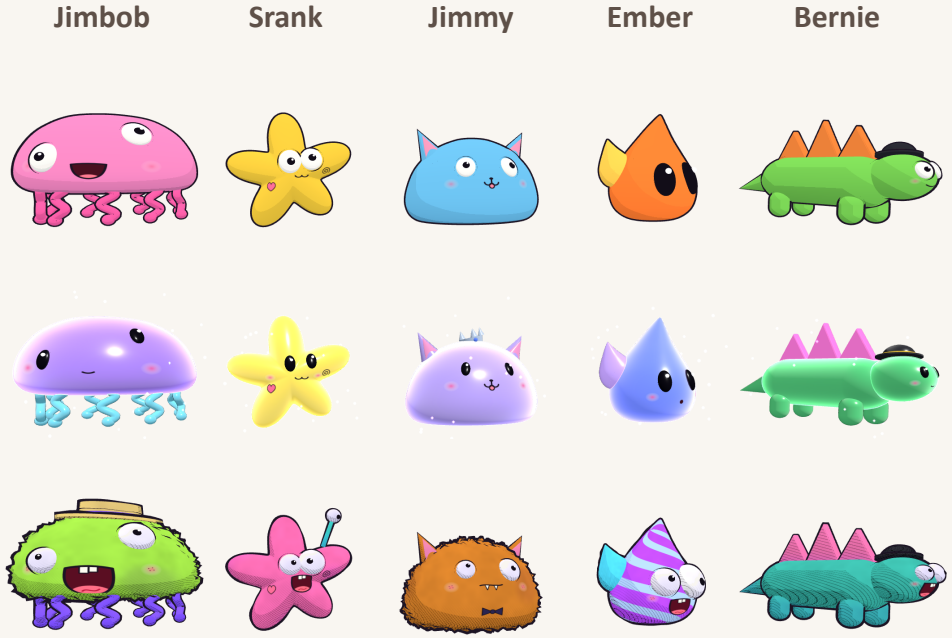
Jimbob, Srank, Jimmy, Ember and Bernie are five characters I invented and first drew in pen on paper. I turned each sketch into a 3D character, then tried every one in three looks inspired by cartoons and games I studied. I included them to show my process: how a quick doodle grows into a finished character without losing what made the drawing special.

1 Sketch on paper



Bernie was almost named Sprout. The old name is still crossed out on the page.

2 Bring them to life in 3D, in three looks



BUILDING & MAKING · WOODWORKING & DIY

Building & Making

WHAT IT IS

Building has always been one of my favorite things to do. These photos show me painting a wooden birdhouse, putting together a balsa-wood glider, and building a big fort with a friend.

MY ROLE

I painted my own design on the birdhouse, assembled the glider piece by piece, and helped build and decorate the fort.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

These early projects are where my love of making things started, and it led to bigger builds like my go-kart.



Birdhouse: from bare wood to finished



Balsa-wood glider



The fort in progress



Finished fort

THEATRE EXPERIENCE · PERFORMANCE

Encanto

WHAT IT IS

Encanto was a youth musical theatre production I performed in, with a big cast, bright costumes and a painted set.

MY ROLE

I was part of the cast, singing and acting on stage alongside everyone else to bring the story to life.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

Being on stage showed me how much the set, costumes and lighting shape a story, and that's the side of theatre I want to learn next.









